

Q75.

Answer: c

Explanation:

- Inter-State trade and commerce is specifically mentioned under Entry 42 of the Union List (List I) in the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India. Therefore, it is a Union subject.
- Inter-State migration, which involves movement of people across state boundaries within India, falls under Entry 81 of the Union List (List I). Hence, it is a Union subject.
- **Inter-State quarantine**, which involves measures for preventing the spread of diseases across state boundaries, is covered under **entry 81 of the Union List (List I)**. Therefore, it is a subject within the exclusive domain of the Union government.
- Fourth statement is incorrect. Corporation tax, which is a form of direct taxation on the income of companies and corporations, falls under Entry 85 of the Union List (List I). Hence, it is under the jurisdiction of the Union government.

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q76.

Answer: d

Explanation: In the landmark case of **Justice K.S. Puttaswamy (Retd.) vs Union of India (2017)**, a nine-judge bench of the Supreme Court unanimously held that the **right to privacy** is protected as an intrinsic part of the right to life and personal liberty under **Article 21 of the Constitution of India**.

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q77.

Answer: d

Explanation:

- The Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) serves as the Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee (COSC), which includes the three Service Chiefs (Army, Navy, Air Force). **So, statement 1 is correct.**
- The CDS does not exercise military command over the three Service Chiefs. Each Service Chief retains operational command over their respective service. **So, statement 2 is not correct.**
- The CDS acts as the Principal Military Advisor to the Defence Minister on all tri-service matters. **So, statement 3 is correct.**

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q78.

Answer: c

Explanation:

- **“Sadbhavana”** literally means “goodwill among people.” The Indian Army has evolved a military strategy of winning hearts and minds, with this being just a phase in the broader war on terror.
- **Operation Sadbhavana** focuses on actions to **address the border regions of Ladakh** in the Himalayas. The government of India, in remote areas, strives against difficult conditions to provide essential services (including health care) to its population in an equitable manner.
- In the backdrop of the deteriorating security situation in the Gulf region, post attacks on merchant ships in the Gulf of Oman in June 2019, Indian Navy had commenced Maritime Security Operations, code named **Op SANKALP**, in the Gulf Region to ensure safe passage of Indian Flag Vessels transiting through the Strait of Hormuz.
- **Operation Maitri** was a rescue and relief operation in Nepal by the government of India and Indian armed forces in the aftermath of the April 2015 Nepal earthquake.

- **Operation “Madad”** has been launched by the **Southern Naval Command (SNC)** at Kochi since 09 Aug 2018 for assisting the state administration and undertaking disaster relief operations due to the unprecedented flooding experienced in many parts of Kerala.

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q79.

Answer: a

Explanation:

- The longest land border between two countries is the border between **Canada and the United States, which is 8,890 kilometers** long. This includes the border between Alaska and northern Canada, as well as the border between Canada and the continental United States.
- Other long borders between countries include:
 - Russia and Kazakhstan: 6,846 kilometers
 - Chile and Argentina: 5,308 kilometers
 - India and Bangladesh: 4,142 kilometers

Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.

Q80.

Answer: c

Explanation:

- The **Committee of Privileges** had recommended the constitution of an Ethics Committee during the 13th Lok Sabha. The late Speaker, G M C Balayogi, constituted an ad hoc Ethics Committee in 2000, which became a permanent part of the House only in 2015. **So, statement 1 is correct.**
- As per **Rule 233A (1) of Chapter XXA**, any person or member may make a complaint relating to unethical conduct of a member of Lok Sabha. Provided that if a complaint is made by any person, it shall be forwarded by a member. **So, statement 2 is not correct.**
- As per **Rule 233A (10) of Chapter XXA**, the Committee on Ethics shall not take up any matter which is sub-judice and the decision of the Committee as to whether such matter is or is not sub-judice shall for the purposes of these rules be treated as final. **So, statement 3 is correct.**

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q81.

Answer: c

Explanation:

- **The Constitution (One Hundred and Sixth Amendment) Act, 2023** (also known as, ‘**Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam**’) was passed in Parliament recently. It seeks to reserve one-third of the total number of seats in Lok Sabha and state legislative assemblies for women.
- Key features of the Bill:
 - **Reservation for women:** It reserves, as nearly as may be, one-third of all seats for women in Lok Sabha, state legislative assemblies, and the Legislative Assembly of the National Capital Territory of Delhi. This will also apply to the seats reserved for SCs and STs in Lok Sabha and states legislatures.
 - **Commencement of reservation:** The reservation will be effective after the census conducted after the commencement of this Act has been published. Based on the census, delimitation will be undertaken to reserve seats for women. The reservation will be provided for a period of 15 years. However, it shall continue till such date as determined by a law made by Parliament. **So, statement 1 is not correct and statement 2 is correct.**
 - **Rotation of seats:** Seats reserved for women will be rotated after each delimitation, as determined by a law made by Parliament.

- It provides for the reservation of seats for Scheduled Castes/Scheduled Tribes Women within the quota reserved for Scheduled Castes/Scheduled Tribes respectively. **So, statement 3 is correct.**

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q82.

Answer: d

Explanation:

- The ninth edition of the Joint Military exercise between India and Sri Lanka named “Exercise MITRA SHAKTI-2023” was conducted in 2023. For the first time this year, Special Forces commandos from Armies and Air Forces of both countries were part of the joint teams. **So, statement 1 is not correct.**
- It commenced at the Foreign Training Node at the Aundh Military Station in Pune. **So, statement 2 is correct.**
- The scope of the exercise includes synergising joint responses during counter-terrorist operations. Both sides will practice tactical actions such as raid, search and destroy missions, and heliborne operations. In addition, Army Martial Arts Routine (AMAR), combat reflex shooting and yoga will also form part of the exercise curriculum during this edition. **So, statement 3 is correct.**
- For the first time this year, Special Forces commandos from Armies and Air Forces of both countries were part of the joint teams. **So, statement 4 is correct.**

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q83.

Answer: c

Explanation:

- Prohibition means ‘to forbid’. It is **issued by a higher court to a lower court or tribunal to prevent the latter from exceeding its jurisdiction** or usurping a jurisdiction that it does not possess. The writ of prohibition can be issued only against judicial and quasi-judicial authorities.
- It is issued when the lower court or tribunal acts without or in excess of jurisdiction or in violation of rules of natural justice or in contravention of fundamental rights. It can also be issued when a lower court or tribunal acts under a law that is itself ultra vires.

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q84.

Answer: b

Explanation:

- The President may, with respect to any State or Union territory, after consultation with the Governor specify the community who is deemed to be scheduled tribes in relation to that state or Union Territory. **So, Statement 1 is not correct.**
- While the Constitution is silent about the criteria for specification of a community as a Scheduled Tribe. The words and the phrase 'tribes or tribal communities or part of or groups within tribes or tribal communities' in Article 342 have to be understood in terms of their historical background of backwardness.
- Primitiveness, geographical isolation, shyness and social, educational & economic backwardness due to these reasons are the traits that distinguish Scheduled Tribe communities of our country from other communities. It takes into account the definitions of tribal Communities adopted in the 1931 Census. These facts are the basis for the provision in Article 342(1) which mandates to specify the tribes or tribal communities or part of or groups within tribes or tribal communities as Scheduled Tribe in relation to that State or Union Territory as the case may be.

- Thus the list of Scheduled Tribes is State/UT specific and a community declared as a Scheduled Tribe in a State need not be so in another State. The Presidential notifications under Clause 1 of Article 342 of the Constitution are issued as the Constitution Orders. **So, Statement 2 is correct.**

Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

Q85.

Answer: b

Explanation:

- As per **Article 112** of the Constitution of India, for every financial year, the President shall cause to be laid before both Houses of Parliament a statement of the estimated receipts and expenditure of the Government of India for that year which would be referred to as annual financial statement. The Union Finance Minister **on behalf of the President of India** lays the Annual Financial Statement before both the Houses of Parliament. **So, statement 1 is not correct.**
- As per **Article 113**, no demand for a grant shall be made except on the recommendation of the President of India. **So, statement 2 is correct.**

Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

Q86.

Answer: d

Explanation:

Subrahmanyam Jaishankar is a prominent Indian diplomat and politician who currently serves as the Minister of External Affairs of India.

- He authored the book "The India Way: Strategies for an Uncertain World," which outlines his vision and thoughts on India's foreign policy and global strategy.
- "Why Bharat Matters" is Jaishankar's second book in which he provided his analysis of India's geopolitical strategy since independence, along with India's historical statecraft and the impact of colonisation.

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.



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Q87.

Answer: b

Explanation:

- **Argentina** faced another severe economic crisis starting in 2018, characterized by a sharp devaluation of the peso, high inflation, and a deep recession. The country entered into a \$57 billion loan agreement with the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the largest in the IMF's history. However, economic instability continued, with rising poverty rates and social unrest. **So, pair 1 is correctly matched.**
- The ongoing conflict in **Sudan** involves the country's regular army, the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF), and a powerful paramilitary group called the Rapid Support Forces (RSF). In April 2023, open warfare erupted between the SAF and the RSF. The conflict has caused widespread devastation, with thousands of civilians killed and millions displaced. The fighting has been characterized by heavy urban combat, airstrikes, and artillery shelling, leading to severe humanitarian crises in cities like Khartoum and Omdurman. **So, pair 2 is correctly matched.**
- NATO was established in 1949 and **Turkey** joined NATO in 1952. Turkey's role within NATO constantly increased since the end of the Cold War. All NATO members need to approve applications from countries seeking to join the alliance. When Sweden and Finland asked to join in 2022, Turkey raised objections. In January 2024, Turkey finally backed Sweden's NATO bid for its inclusion. **So, pair 3 is not correctly matched.**

So, only two of the above pairs are correctly matched.

Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

Q88.

Answer: a

Explanation:

- The Suez Canal, the SUMED pipeline, and the Bab el-Mandeb Strait are strategic routes for Persian Gulf oil and natural gas shipments to Europe and North America. Total oil shipments via these routes accounted for about 12% of total seaborne-traded oil in the first half of 2023, and liquefied natural gas (LNG) shipments accounted for about 8% of worldwide LNG trade. **So, statement 1 is correct.**
- The Suez Canal and SUMED pipeline are located in Egypt and connect the Red Sea with the Mediterranean Sea. The SUMED pipeline transports crude oil north through Egypt and has a capacity of 2.5 million barrels per day. **So, statement 2 is correct.**

Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.

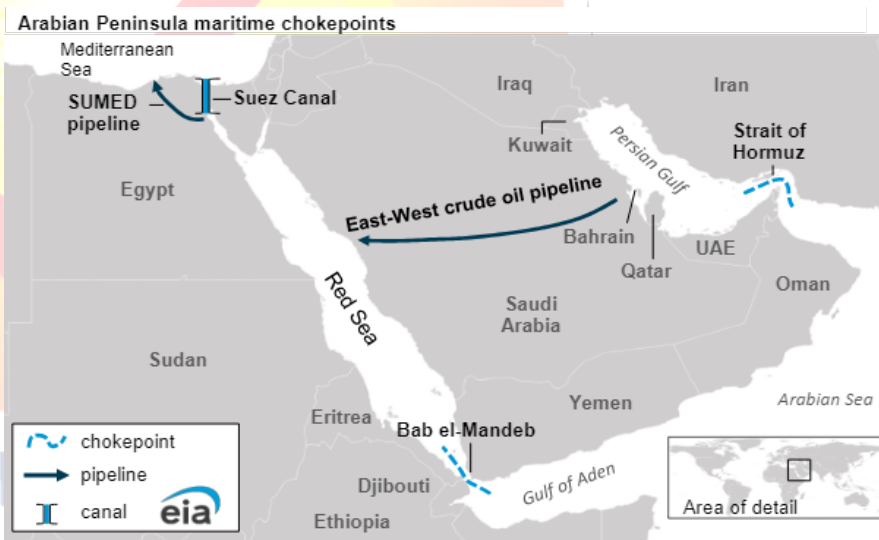
Q89.

Answer: c

Explanation:

Red Sea, narrow strip of water extending southeastward from Suez, Egypt, for about 1,200 miles (1,930 km) to the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, which connects with the Gulf of Aden and thence with the Arabian Sea.

- The Red Sea contains some of the world's hottest and saltiest seawater. With its connection to the Mediterranean Sea via the Suez Canal. Because, The Red Sea region **receives very little precipitation** in any form. **So, statement 1 is correct.**



- **No water enters the Red Sea from rivers**, and rainfall is scant; but the evaporation loss—in excess of 80 inches per year—is made up by an inflow through the eastern channel of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait from the Gulf of Aden. **So, statement 2 is correct.**

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q90.

Answer: d

Explanation:

Sulfur dioxide (SO₂) is a colorless, reactive air pollutant with a strong odor. This gas can be a threat to human health, animal health & plant life. The gas contributes to the formation of acid rain and in high concentrations can cause respiratory problems.

- The largest source of SO₂ in the atmosphere is the burning of fossil fuels by power plants and other industrial facilities. Smaller sources of SO₂ emissions include: industrial processes such as extracting metal from ore; natural sources such as volcanoes; & locomotives, ships & other equipment that burn fuel with a high sulfur content.
- According to a report by Greenpeace (an environmental Non-Governmental Organization), India is the largest emitter of Sulphur Dioxide (SO₂) in the world, contributing more than 15% of global anthropogenic emissions.

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q91.

Answer: a

Explanation:

The Sahel region is spanning the area from Senegal to Eritrea, situated between the Sahara to the north and the African tropics to the south, the Sahel region has long faced severe, complex security and humanitarian crises.

- Sahel have experienced violent extremism due to the confluence of weak and illegitimate governance, economic decline, and the worsening effects of climate change. Violence, conflict, and crime have surged over the last decade, transcending national borders and posing significant challenges to countries both in and outside the region. **So, statement 1 is correct.**
- The epicenters of violence and humanitarian disaster are in the Liptako-Gourma and Lake Chad Basin subregions.
- Liptako-Gourma is in the central Sahel, in the borderlands of Burkina Faso, Mali, and Niger. Current instability is associated with the collapse of the Libyan state in 2011, which led to the proliferation of weapons and armed fighters in the region. **So, statement 2 is correct.**
- Violent extremism in the Lake Chad Basin at the intersection of Cameroon, Chad, Niger, and Nigeria prevailed in the same period with the reemergence of Boko Haram in northern Nigeria.
- In 2023, security forces in Mali and Burkina Faso faced allegations of civilian massacres.

Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.



Q92.

Answer: d

Explanation:

- After India removed 'retaliatory import duty' on US apples in September, imports of American apples have surged 40 times in three months, while traders are hopeful of regaining market share. In 2017-18, the import of US apples was a record of over 7 million boxes, which dropped to 50,000 boxes in the 2022-23 (September–August) season. **So, statement 1 is not correct.**
- In India, the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006, prohibits import, manufacture, use or sale of GM food without FSSAI's approval. 11 Nov. **So, statement 2 is correct.**

Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct.

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q93.

Answer: a

Explanation:

- When any resolution for the removal of the Speaker of the Lok Sabha is under consideration, he cannot preside at the sitting of the Lok Sabha. However, he may be present in the house. **So, Statement 1 is correct.**
- When any resolution for the removal of the Speaker of the Lok Sabha is under consideration, he can speak and take part in the proceedings of the House. **So, Statement 2 is incorrect.**
- When any resolution for the removal of the Speaker of the Lok Sabha is under consideration, he is entitled to vote in the first instance and not in the case of an equality of votes. **So, Statement 3 is incorrect.**

Therefore, option (a) is the correct answer.

Q94.

Answer: b

Explanation:

- When the Lok Sabha is dissolved, a bill pending in the Lok Sabha lapses (whether originating in the Lok Sabha or transmitted to it by the Rajya Sabha). **So, Statement 1 is correct.**
- When the Lok Sabha is dissolved, a bill passed by the Lok Sabha but pending in the Rajya Sabha lapses. **So, Statement 2 is correct.**
- When the Lok Sabha is dissolved, a bill does not lapse if the President has notified the holding of a joint sitting before the dissolution of Lok Sabha. **So, Statement 3 is incorrect.**

Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

Q95.

Answer: c

Explanation:

- Under Article 85(2) of the Constitution of India, the President may from time to time prorogue Houses or either House of Parliament. Termination of a session of the House by an Order by the President under the above constitutional provision is called 'prorogation'. The President exercises this power of Prorogation of the Houses only on the recommendation of the Prime Minister or the Cabinet i.e. the Council of Ministers. **So, Statement 1 is incorrect.**
- Prorogation normally follows the adjournment of the sitting of the House sine die. The time-lag between the adjournment of the House sine die and its prorogation is generally two to four days. However, the President can also prorogue the House while in session. **So, Statement 2 is correct.**
- The President of India can dissolve the Lok Sabha before the expiry of its term on the advice of the Union Council of Ministers. **So, Statement 3 is correct.**

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q96.

Answer: c

Explanation:

- The European Parliament has approved the **Net-Zero Industry Act** to enhance net-zero technology production within the European Union. The Act targets Europe to produce 40% of its net-zero technology needs by 2030 and capture 15% of the global market for these technologies. **So, statement 1 is correct.**
- The European Union intends to achieve carbon neutrality by 2050 and therefore aims to develop all of its own clean technology by that time. **So, statement 2 is not correct.**

Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q97.

Answer: d

Explanation:

- The crisis in Venezuela continues to escalate, with no recovery or relief in sight. More than 7.7 million people have fled Venezuela, seeking food and better living conditions. Venezuela has not achieved a rapid recovery from its economic crisis and has not been successful in preventing its people from fleeing/emigrating to other countries. **So, statement 1 is not correct.**
- According to the 2022 BP Statistical Review of World Energy, Venezuela has more proved oil reserves than any other country in the world. Venezuela is currently the country with the largest proven oil reserves in the world, with an estimated 300 billion barrels of oil. **So, statement 2 is correct.**

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.



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Q98.

Answer: d

Explanation:

- Digital India Land Records Modernization Programme (erstwhile National Land Record Modernization Programme-) was revamped and converted as a Central Sector Scheme with effect from 1st April, 2016 with **100% funding by the Centre. So, statement 1 is correct.**
- 68.02 percent **Cadastral Maps have been digitized** (2,49,57,221 maps out of total 3,66,92,728 maps), 94.95 per cent Computerization of Registration completed (5060 Sub-Registrar Offices out of total 5,329 SROs) and 87.48 per cent Integration of Sub Registrar offices(SROs) with Land Records have been completed (4,662 SROs out of total 5329 SROs). **So, statement 2 is correct.**
- The Government with the technical support of Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) Pune, has undertaken **an initiative to transliterate the Records of Rights available in local language to any of the 22 Schedule VIII languages of the Constitution.** Pilot test is underway in 8 States - Bihar, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Puducherry, Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nādu, Tripura and UT of Jammu & Kashmir. **So, statement 3 is correct.**

Therefore, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q99.

Answer: b

Explanation:

- Government of India launched “Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan” (PMSMA) with an aim to provide fixed-day, free of cost, assured, comprehensive and quality antenatal care on the 9th day of every month universally to all pregnant women in their 2nd / 3rd trimesters of pregnancy. **So, statement 1 is not correct.**
- The programme follows a systematic approach for engagement with the private sector which includes motivating private practitioners to volunteer for the campaign developing strategies for generating awareness and appealing to the private sector to participate in the Abhiyan at government health facilities. **So, statement 2 is correct.**

Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

Q100.

Answer: b

Explanation:

- To become eligible to avail benefits of the PM-SYM Yojana, a person should be:
 - An unorganised worker
 - Entry age between 18 and 40 years
 - Monthly Income Rs 15000 or below. **So, statement 1 is not correct.**
- It is a voluntary and contributory pension scheme under which the beneficiary would receive a minimum assured pension of Rs 3000/- per month after attaining the age of 60 years. **So, statement 2 is correct.**
- During the receipt of pension, if the subscriber dies, the spouse of the beneficiary shall be entitled to receive 50% of the pension received by the beneficiary as family pension. **Family pension is applicable only to spouse** Subscriber needs to contribute in the range of Rs. 55 - Rs. 200 depending on the entry age specific monthly contribution. **So, statement 3 is correct and 4 is not correct.**

Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.